Plural Marriage in Kirtland and Nauvoo

The Belief Files

Case File 009

Historical investigation and biblical assessment

Beyond the Message | Prepared for Jamie Dennis | November 8, 2026

Investigation summary

Joseph Smith's plural marriages are a test of religious authority as well as a subject of family history. What evidence establishes the relationships? What supports the claim that God commanded them? How should a Christian evaluate secrecy, consent, and promises of eternal reward when the religious leader making those promises is also entering the marriages?

The records do establish Smith's participation in plural marriage. The historical case does not rest solely on accusations by opponents. Surviving correspondence, a marriage instruction, a written revelation, and later participant testimony provide different kinds of evidence. They do not independently establish the divine origin of the practice. [3,5–6,9]

This investigation follows the supplied general plural-marriage packet into the more specific Kirtland and Nauvoo record. It distinguishes a document's original date from the date of a surviving copy, a woman's experience from a later explanation of it, and a documented relationship from uncertain details of private life. The Christian assessment is stated separately. [1]

The central concern is whether a claimed revelation deserves obedience. Neither dismissing every participant as dishonest nor accepting every spiritual interpretation would answer that question. The women involved should be heard as people, not reduced to a count of wives or a device in an argument.

The claim under investigation

The official LDS account presents plural marriage as a difficult divine command associated with restoration and eternal sealing. It acknowledges confidentiality and an incomplete record. It also distinguishes relationships for time and eternity from sealings understood to concern eternity alone. The Church's claim is therefore more specific than the assertion that every sealing produced the same kind of household. [2]

Doctrine and Covenants 132 connects priesthood authority, enduring marriage, exaltation, and authorized plural marriage. It gives promises and warnings, addresses Emma Smith, and includes both a first wife's consent provision and an exemption from the law of Sarah. Those features belong in the examination together. [4]

The questions are historical and theological: What relationships and instructions are documented? What did participants understand themselves to be accepting? What would establish that the command came from God? This case does not assume that proving the first question proves the last.

How this investigation weighs evidence

The strongest evidence for an instruction is a surviving contemporary document or an identifiable contemporary copy. A late account can still preserve important firsthand information, but time, purpose, transmission, and corroboration matter. A claim that Smith described seeing an angel is evidence about his reported explanation; it is not a second person's observation of that angel.

Three distinctions are especially important. A civil marriage and an LDS sealing are not identical categories. A record of a sealing does not settle every question about cohabitation or sexual relations. Finally, a profession of willingness does not tell us everything about the spiritual, familial, or social pressures surrounding the choice.

The source register identifies what was actually checked. This is not a new census of every wife, an audit of every Temple Lot deposition, or a claim to have reconstructed conversations for which no record survives.

The historical timeline

Date	Evidence or development	What needs distinguishing
Mid-1830s	The disputed Kirtland relationship with Fanny Alger.	Near-contemporary controversy and much later marriage recollections. [7–8]
August 1835	A published Church marriage statement affirms monogamy.	An institutional statement, not a revelation dictated by Smith. [12]
1841	Nauvoo plural marriage develops; the official account identifies Louisa Beaman as its first plural wife.	The event and the later evidentiary reconstruction of its details. [2]
July-August 1842	Whitney marriage instructions and Smith's letter to the Whitney family.	A transmitted revelation text and an extant contemporary letter. [5–6]
May-July 1843	Helen Mar Kimball's sealing; dictation of the July 12 revelation.	Later personal recollection, contemporary recording, and surviving copies. [3,9–10,13]
1844	Smith dies; the Nauvoo practice remains incompletely documented.	Later defense and denial must be compared with earlier records. [2]
1879-1881	Emma's reported denial is published; Helen writes her autobiography.	Conflicting later testimony and the circumstances of its transmission. [9,14]

Exhibit one The Kirtland record

Fanny Alger lived and worked in the Smith household. The Church's historical account describes fragmentary evidence of a plural marriage in the mid-1830s, drawing substantially on later recollections. The surviving record does not supply a contemporary marriage certificate or a complete account from Alger of the relationship. A confident retelling of every conversation would go beyond it. [7]

Oliver Cowdery's January 1838 letter to Smith shows a serious dispute over allegations Cowdery believed he had truthfully made. The Joseph Smith Papers connects it with the Alger controversy; the April 1838 disciplinary minutes provide additional evidence of the conflict. These sources establish disagreement close to the period. They do not independently settle the ceremony, its exact date, or each participant's understanding. [8]

An allegation of adultery and a later recollection of authorized marriage are competing interpretations of a relationship, not two interchangeable descriptions. The religious status asserted by supporters cannot simply be assumed. Equally, the absence of a surviving certificate is not proof that no ceremony occurred.

The appropriate finding is qualified: the relationship was an early source of conflict; the marriage interpretation has historical support but depends on retrospective evidence for important details. The more fully documented Nauvoo materials must not be projected backward as though every later regulation were already written and known in Kirtland.

Exhibit two The Nauvoo documents

A marriage instruction and its copies

The July 27, 1842 Whitney revelation gives instructions for Newel K. Whitney to unite his daughter Sarah Ann with Smith. Its text promises enduring family blessings and reserves rights already given to Smith. This is evidence of a specific claimed authorization, rather than merely a general rumor about plural marriage. [5]

The manuscript history matters. The Joseph Smith Papers features a 1912 typescript whose family transmission is described, alongside nineteenth-century manuscript copies with less certain provenance. The original is not extant. Calling the featured page an original written in 1842 would erase that distinction; calling the entire instruction a modern invention merely because this typescript is later would erase the other copies and corroborating evidence. [5]

The August 18 letter

Smith's August 18, 1842 letter to Newel, Elizabeth Ann, and Sarah Ann Whitney survives in a much more direct form. He requested a discreet visit, cautioned about Emma's presence, and instructed the recipients to destroy the letter. It was addressed to a family, not simply a solitary invitation to Sarah Ann. Smith was also in hiding from threatened arrest and extradition, giving the secrecy more than one possible purpose. [6]

Those qualifications do not remove the concern about concealment from Emma. A threat of arrest can explain protecting a location; it does not automatically explain every instruction about a spouse's presence. Conversely, the letter does not prove the proposed visit occurred or establish what took place if it did. Its force is in what it actually records.

The July 12 revelation

The Joseph Smith Papers identifies the surviving principal copy of the July 12, 1843 revelation as Joseph Kingsbury's. William Clayton recorded the dictation in his journal, and the document circulated privately before its later publication. The evidence supports a Nauvoo origin; this case does not treat it as a revelation first created in Utah. [3,13]

The present canonical text makes the authority claim explicit. Verses 19-20 connect a properly sealed marriage with exaltation. Verses 51-56 address Emma, including warnings of destruction for rejecting what is presented as divine law. Verses 61-65 discuss consent, plural wives, and exemption from the law of Sarah. These are substantive religious instructions, not merely a private expression of affection. [4]

Assessment: the contemporary letter and the transmitted marriage texts give strong evidence that Smith practiced and authorized plural marriage. Their preservation establishes human claims, words, and actions. Acceptance of the asserted heavenly source requires a further judgment.

Exhibit three Women consent and differing relationships

Helen Mar Kimball

Helen was fourteen when sealed to Smith in 1843. Her 1881 autobiography recalls her father's involvement, Smith's explanation, the promise of salvation and exaltation for her and her family, and her willingness in response to that promise. It also describes emotional cost and disappointed expectations. This is her own later account, written about thirty-eight years after the event, rather than a diary entry from the day. [9–10]

A responsible reading keeps both willingness and pressure visible. Her later defense of plural marriage should not be suppressed; neither should her youth, the adults' authority, or the weight of a promise involving her family's eternal future. Recognizing that power difference is moral analysis, not a claim that we can recover every thought she had at fourteen.

The official account interprets her eternity-only language as suggesting an absence of sexual relations. Suggestion is not demonstration. This case makes no finding that she had a sexual relationship with Smith, and it does not turn that uncertainty into proof that the arrangement carried no present obligations or burdens. A discussion of consent should not depend on sensational speculation. [2,9]

Already-married women

Zina Huntington Jacobs is a documented example of a woman civilly married to another man when sealed to Smith. The Church biography records her marriage to Henry Jacobs, subsequent sealing to Smith, religious testimony, and later complex relationships. That establishes a real distinction between civil household arrangements and claims about eternal bonds. [11]

It does not establish the nature of every other woman's sealing. Some participants described eternity-only relationships; for others the evidence is incomplete. Neither a universal sexual interpretation nor a universal nonsexual interpretation follows from the existence of sealings. Whether a particular arrangement was moral and whether it involved sexual relations are also different questions. [2]

Emma and the consent rule

The consent issue is visible in the revelation itself. A provision requesting a first wife's agreement cannot be read apart from the concluding exemption when she does not accept the law. Within the text, her refusal does not operate as an unconditional veto. A reader should assess the whole rule rather than presenting only its reassuring half. [4]

Clayton's journal, quoted in the Joseph Smith Papers, reports Emma's rejection when the revelation was presented to her. That is Clayton's observation and characterization, not Emma's own written account. The distinction matters especially where his description evaluates her attitude. [13]

The later interview published as Emma's last testimony denies that Smith had other wives or taught plural marriage to her knowledge. It was recorded by her son Joseph Smith III and published after her death in 1879. It must be considered, but its broad denial conflicts with the earlier documentary record and participant evidence. A loyal family witness is not automatically immune to error; neither is she automatically dishonest because other evidence challenges her statement. [14]

Assessment: claims that Emma approved everything, knew nothing, or left a complete transparent account of her experience all outrun the evidence. The sources establish conflict and important limits on her knowledge more securely than they establish her complete inner reasoning.

Exhibit four The angel and spiritual testimony

The LDS essay recounts Smith telling associates that an angel pressed him to introduce plural marriage, finally threatening destruction with a drawn sword. The evidentiary distinction is crucial: these are reports about Smith's claimed encounter, preserved through later accounts. They are not independent eyewitness reports of the angel appearing before each wife or associate. [2]

Women and men also described prayer, conviction, sacrifice, and spiritual assurance. Helen's autobiography and Zina's recorded recollection show that religious interpretation mattered to participants. Taking their testimony seriously does not require accepting the proposition that their interpretation was divinely confirmed. [9,11]

The same standard should govern Christian testimony. An experience can be sincere and consequential while its explanation remains open to examination. A threatening supernatural command particularly requires a standard of testing beyond the authority of the person reporting it.

Assessing the principal accounts

Evidence	Main contribution	Limitation
Alger material and Cowdery dispute	Establish an early controversy and competing interpretations.	Important marriage details are retrospective or missing. [7–8]
Whitney instruction	Preserves a specific marriage authorization and promises.	Survives through copies; the featured typescript is later. [5]

Evidence	Main contribution	Limitation
Whitney letter	Contemporary instructions for secrecy and a family visit.	Does not establish that the visit occurred. [6]
Kingsbury copy and Clayton journal	Support the July 1843 revelation's historical setting.	A surviving copy and a clerk's account are not the lost original or divine verification. [3,13]
Helen's autobiography	Gives a woman's remembered motives, costs, and defense.	Written decades later, with adult interpretation of youthful experience. [9]
Emma's reported interview	Preserves a later denial from Smith's widow.	Son-mediated, posthumously published, and in conflict with earlier evidence. [14]

Participants belonged to overlapping families and religious networks. Their accounts should not be counted as though every statement arose independently. Nor should institutional affiliation automatically disqualify a source. Agreement has evidential value when we can identify what is agreed, how it was known, and whether accounts depend on one another.

The strongest LDS argument

The strongest LDS explanation starts with authorized exception. Monogamy is the ordinary rule, but God may command a difficult exception through a prophet. Biblical patriarchs practiced polygyny, Jacob 2:30 allows a commanded exception in LDS scripture, and D&C 132 presents sealing as part of restored authority. Participants' reluctance and later religious conviction can be offered as evidence that they were seeking obedience rather than ordinary social advantage. [4,15]

This argument also distinguishes authorized plural marriage from exploitative spiritual wifery, and different types of sealing from a uniform

pattern of domestic relationships. Those distinctions deserve examination. A critique that ignores them does not engage the actual claim.

The unresolved issue is verification of authority. If the prophet's command establishes the exception, and willingness to accept the exception establishes faithfulness to the prophet, the argument can become circular. Independent examination must ask whether the purported authorization agrees with the biblical standard, how people could question it, and what protected those asked to comply.

Reluctance and sacrifice may support sincerity. They do not by themselves establish divine origin. The same applies to a critic who suffered after leaving: cost alone does not make every later accusation true.

Competing explanations

A divine command carried out imperfectly

This is the faithful LDS explanation. It can account for prayer, costly obedience, and the integration of sealing with wider LDS theology. Its hardest questions concern the grounds for identifying the command as divine and the moral force of warnings, secrecy, and uneven knowledge. Calling implementation imperfect should not prevent asking which instructions were themselves wrong.

Sincere religious innovation

Smith and followers may have interpreted new family arrangements as revelation through their reading of ancient precedent, spiritual experience, and expectations about eternity. This explanation can accommodate sincere belief without affirming the heavenly source. It must still explain the specific documents and the authority structure, not simply diagnose participants from a distance.

The use of religious authority for personal benefit

Another explanation emphasizes the opportunity for a leader to acquire additional relationships and loyalty through claims of exceptional divine permission. The structure creates an evident conflict of interest. Establishing that structure is easier than establishing the full mixture of motives in every decision. The record should be evaluated for concealment, benefits, pressure, and counterevidence rather than treated as a license to invent private intent.

These explanations can overlap at the level of human behavior. A person can believe a doctrine sincerely and benefit from it, while another accepts it under substantial pressure. The investigator needs to distinguish the practice's effects from an unqualified verdict on every participant's heart.

Motives benefits and costs

The benefit under investigation is not only sexual access. Family status, proximity to a prophet, promised eternal kinship, institutional solidarity, and authority to define exceptions are also relevant. The documents themselves connect marriage with eternal reward, which gives a concrete basis for examining spiritual incentives. [4–5,9]

Costs included secrecy, conflict, social isolation, and reputational risk. Helen's retrospective testimony is especially important because it connects her willing response with both promised reward and later pain. Acknowledging her defense of the principle does not require treating those costs as proof that the arrangement was good. [9]

Neither benefit nor suffering determines truth automatically. The question remains whether the teaching was trustworthy and whether the people asked to obey could make an informed choice without having their relationship with God made dependent on the leader's personal request.

A biblical assessment

Ancient precedent requires careful reading

The Old Testament does record plural marriages and regulates situations involving more than one wife. Exodus 21:10 and Deuteronomy 21:15-17 protect obligations within such households. Deuteronomy 25:5-10 concerns duty to a deceased brother's household; Second Samuel 12:8 invokes the royal household in Nathan's rebuke of David. A Christian should not claim that every difficult text is absent or that all such passages simply pronounce every polygamous household invalid. [16]

The project's Christian conclusion instead rests on the distinction between ancient accommodation and a command for the church to restore polygyny. Jesus appeals to the creation account in Matthew 19:4-6 and describes the two becoming one flesh in a discussion about divorce. That is not a sentence addressing every historical polygamy question, but it is a significant statement of the marital pattern to which Jesus directs his hearers. [17]

First Timothy 3:2 describes an overseer as the husband of one wife. Christians debate the phrase's emphasis on marital fidelity and its application to remarriage. Ephesians 5:25-33 calls a husband to sacrificial love. Read together with Jesus' appeal to creation, these texts support this case's monogamous Christian assessment. The conclusion is a theological synthesis, not a claim that one disputed expression settles everything. [18]

Consent and truthful dealing

Spiritual leadership should serve the people entrusted to it. A teacher's personal interest increases the need for accountability. Threats of destruction or promises encompassing a family's eternal future should be tested rather than accepted simply because an admired leader speaks them. Galatians 1:8 tests even an angelic message against the gospel; First John 4:1 calls believers to test spiritual claims. These passages require discernment, not automatic acceptance or automatic dismissal of every experience. [19]

Within LDS scripture, Jacob 2 condemns destructive conduct involving wives and children while allowing a divinely commanded exception in verse 30. D&C 132 explains authorized and unauthorized relationships differently. An LDS reader may use that distinction to reconcile the texts. The Christian question remains what establishes authorization; naming an exception does not demonstrate that Smith possessed it. [4,15]

Eternal life and marriage

Matthew 22:23-33 describes the resurrection in response to a question about successive marriages. LDS interpreters distinguish marriages made after resurrection from prior sealings. This case recognizes that explanation while finding no positive institution of Smith's sealing system in Jesus' answer. Historical proof that a sealing occurred is not biblical proof that it secures exaltation. [17]

Ephesians 2:8-10 places salvation in God's grace received through faith, with good works as its result. First John 5:11-13 locates eternal life in the Son. From this evangelical perspective, assurance should rest in Christ rather than a promise that entering a particular relationship with a religious leader secures an extended family's eternal destiny. [20]

The critique applies to any Christian leader who makes personal access, money, loyalty, or a private relationship the measure of faithfulness to God. It should lead us to examine our own communities as carefully as another's.

Findings and confidence

Finding	Assessment	Boundary
Smith practiced and authorized Nauvoo plural marriage.	Strongly established.	Contemporary and transmitted documents converge with participant testimony. [3,5–6]
Every Kirtland detail is certain.	Not established.	The Alger record is incomplete and important details are late. [7–8]
Every sealing involved the same earthly relationship.	Not established.	The record contains distinctions and silences; examine individuals. [2,11]
Consent can be assessed by quoting only one provision.	Inadequate.	D&C 132 includes both consent language and an exemption. [4]
Several associates independently saw the commanding angel.	Not established here.	The accounts report Smith's claim, not separate observations of that encounter. [2]
Documentation establishes a divine command.	Does not follow.	Historical occurrence and theological authorization remain separate judgments.

Overall assessment

The documentary evidence supports the reality of Smith's plural marriage practice more securely than later comprehensive denial. It also shows that religious authority, eternal promises, secrecy, and family relationships were intertwined. Those are appropriate subjects of historical and moral investigation.

Some private details remain unresolved. Precision requires resisting both sensational certainty and defensive certainty where the evidence is incomplete. The women involved should not have their testimony selectively edited to make either a wholly triumphant or a wholly uniform story.

From this case's Christian perspective, the claim to restore authorized plural marriage is not established by the cited biblical precedents or the surviving historical documents. The central authority question remains: why should a later prophet's claim control the interpretation of marriage, conscience, and eternal life? That question can be asked firmly while respecting the people who answer differently.

Read compare and discuss

1. Which source most directly establishes an actual instruction rather than a later interpretation?
2. How does the Whitney revelation's copy history affect what we should call the surviving document?
3. What does the August 18 letter establish? What does it leave unknown?
4. How can Helen's willingness, youth, religious conviction, and pain be considered together?
5. What changes when the full consent and exemption language is read?
6. Which Old Testament passages complicate an overly simple Christian argument? How does Jesus' appeal to creation shape your conclusion?
7. What evidence would distinguish sincere belief from divine authorization?
8. What protections should your own church provide when a leader's request benefits that leader personally?

For a conversation with an LDS friend, begin with a source rather than an accusation: Would you be willing to read the marriage revelation with me and explain how you understand its authority? Listen to the distinction your friend makes between a prophet, a policy, and a personal mistake.

Then explain positively why you trust Christ for eternal life and why Scripture governs your response to later claims. Do not ask your friend to defend unknown details of every marriage. A useful conversation can be honest about uncertainty while still reaching a clear theological

disagreement. First Peter 3:15-16 and James 3 require that our manner remain accountable to the faith we profess. [21]

Accuracy notes and further research

- The compilation supplies a general plural-marriage overview, not the complete surviving record for this case. The case adds specifically identified documents and published histories. [1]
- The Kingsbury copy, the Whitney typescript, and Smith's surviving letter have different transmission histories. Do not label all of them original manuscripts in Smith's hand.
- Helen's autobiography and Emma's reported interview are later accounts. Their dates, purposes, and conflicts belong beside their claims.
- Sealing, civil marriage, household membership, and sexual relations must not be treated as equivalent facts. No intimate relationship involving Helen is established by this investigation.
- The angel material does not supply multiple independent witnesses to the angel. It supplies evidence of reported religious claims.
- The case does not claim a full audit of Temple Lot testimony, all plural-wife affidavits, or every archival original. A book treatment should compare those materials and the manuscript images in greater detail.
- Modern LDS members are not personally responsible for the Nauvoo practice. Present policy prohibits plural marriage; detailed discontinuation belongs to Cases 010 and 011. [22]

Sources and reading

Web sources were checked November 8, 2026, local project date. Biblical texts use the KJV. A source's historical content is distinguished from modern editorial explanation, and a published transcription is identified where no independent inspection of an original is claimed.

[1] Supplied compilation. LDS Gospel Topics Essays .pdf, physical pages 231-241, general plural-marriage packet. Used as the project overview and claim inventory; its later topic branches require additional evidence.

[2] Official LDS case framing. Plural Marriage in Kirtland and Nauvoo, Gospel Topics Essays. Used for the Church's claim, sealing distinctions, and account of the reported angel. A modern institutional synthesis rather than an independent eyewitness record.

[3] The 1843 revelation manuscript history. Revelation July 12 1843, Joseph Smith Papers, source note and historical introduction. Identifies Kingsbury's surviving copy and the context of dictation. The edition's reconstruction is distinguished from the underlying text.

[4] Current canonical text. Doctrine and Covenants 132, especially verses 19-20, 34-39, 51-56, and 61-65. Read for its claims, promises, conditions, warnings, and consent exemption; canonical status is an LDS claim rather than an assumption of this comparison.

[5] Whitney marriage instruction. Revelation July 27 1842, Joseph Smith Papers. The featured 1912 typescript has an identified family transmission; earlier manuscript copies are also described. The original is not extant.

[6] Contemporary private correspondence. Letter to the Whitney family August 18 1842 and page two, Joseph Smith Papers. Document and historical introduction checked. The letter's recipients, concealment instructions, and arrest context must remain together.

[7] Alger historical account. Fanny Alger, Church History Topics. Used with its fragmentary and retrospective evidence clearly identified; not presented as a contemporary certificate or Alger's own full narrative.

[8] Cowdery dispute. Letter from Oliver Cowdery January 21 1838 and Minutes April 12 1838, Joseph Smith Papers. The former is a letter to Smith; it must not be confused with Cowdery's separate letter to his brother of the same date.

[9] Helen's retrospective testimony. Helen Mar Kimball Whitney, Autobiography, March 30, 1881, Church History Library MS 744, published transcription and archival reference. The transcription was checked; no fresh physical-manuscript inspection is claimed.

[10] Helen's biographical context. Helen Mar Kimball Whitney, Church History Topics. Used for age, later life, and her published defense of plural marriage; distinguish later interpretation from the 1881 document.

[11] A specific already-married woman. Zina D H Jacobs Young, Church History Topics. A modern biography with references to her remembered religious conviction and complex relationships; not proof of every other woman's circumstances.

[12] Public marriage statement. Statement on Marriage circa August 1835, as published in Messenger and Advocate, Joseph Smith Papers edition. Evidence of a public institutional statement affirming monogamy, not a Smith-authored marriage revelation.

[13] Recording and Emma's response. Journal July 12 1843, Joseph Smith Papers, including its quotation of Clayton's journal. The case relies on that published quotation rather than claiming independent access to the complete Clayton manuscript.

[14] Emma's later reported denial. Last Testimony of Sister Emma, Saints' Herald, October 1, 1879, page 289, transcription and source pointer. Son-mediated testimony published after her death; the transcript is not assumed to be an unedited recording.

[15] LDS exception text. Jacob 2, especially verses 23-35. Includes condemnation, the exception in verse 30, and the suffering of wives and children. The comparison represents the LDS reading before questioning its authorization.

[16] Old Testament evidence. Genesis 2:24; Genesis 16; Exodus 21:10; Deuteronomy 21:15-17 and 25:5-10; 2 Samuel 12:7-9. These include creation, narrative, regulation, levirate duty, and royal-household language. They must not all be assigned the same literary or legal function.

[17] Jesus on marriage. Matthew 19:3-12 and Matthew 22:23-33. The first addresses divorce through creation; the second addresses resurrection. The project's Christian synthesis and the LDS response are distinguished.

[18] Christian household and leadership. 1 Timothy 3:1-7 and Ephesians 5:21-33. The case acknowledges interpretive debate about marital fidelity and remarriage rather than using a contested phrase without explanation.

[19] Testing revelation. Galatians 1:6-9 and 1 John 4:1-6. The texts call for testing messages by the gospel and Christ; an account of an angel does not exempt a message from examination.

[20] Eternal life in Christ. Ephesians 2:8-10 and 1 John 5:11-13. Ground the evangelical comparison of grace, faith, good works, and assurance in the Son.

[21] The manner of witness. 1 Peter 3:15-16 and James 3:1, 13-18. Ground a respectful conversation and the accountability of teachers, including Christian teachers making this comparison.

[22] Contemporary policy and later history. Plural Marriage and Families in Early Utah, opening discussion of discontinuation and current membership. Used here only to distinguish present policy from historical practice; Cases 010 and 011 investigate the transition.